

## OGUST CONVENTION

### ABOUT THE DEALS

You will always be in the South position. Either you or partner may open the bidding.

The first page (or two) of each Deal shows only your hand. The initial bidding is given and you are asked to decide what you would bid, then click the word **BID** up in the bidding table. The next page will then appear showing the recommended bid and continuing the auction. On the final page of each Deal partner's hand will be shown.

### ABOUT OGUST

First let's review the "standard" bidding which follows a Weak 2-bid opening.

If the Responder has an interest in going higher he bids 2NT.

The Weak-2 opener replies as follows:

- With a minimum, rebid the suit at the 3-level
- With a maximum, show a feature (Ace or King) of an outside suit by bidding that suit at the 3-level
- With a solid suit (A K Q x x x) bid 3NT

If you are happy with that method just stop reading this and go over to the Weak 2-bid topic for some practice!

#### Ogust rebids:

As the popularity of Weak 2-bids has increased, the requirement for suit quality has declined. Many of today's players ignore the old requirement that you should have 2 of the top 3 honors, (or 3 honors altogether) in the suit.

A hand like ♠ 5 ♥ Q 9 8 6 5 3 ♦ A 7 3 ♣ 9 6 2  
might be opened 2♥ by an opponent.

Or, you might fall under the spell and open 2♥ with the hand yourself.

Harold Ogust developed a convention to allow Responder to obtain more information from the Weak-2 opener. The Ogust Convention also starts with Responder bidding 2NT, but Opener's rebids are more descriptive.

| OPENER REBIDS AFTER OGUST 2NT |                  |           |
|-------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 3♣                            | minimum hand     | poor suit |
| 3♦                            | minimum hand     | good suit |
| 3♥                            | maximum hand     | poor suit |
| 3♠                            | maximum hand     | good suit |
| 3NT                           | A K Q x x x suit |           |

In theory, once the Responder learns which of the five categories Opener falls into he should be able to set the contract correctly.

Of course it is important that the partners are agreed on the meanings of minimum/maximum and poor/good.

Here are our suggestions:

Assuming your Weak 2-bid strength is 6-11 total points, use 6-8 as minimum, 9-11 as maximum.

A good suit is headed by any two of the top three honors ( A K Q ) a poor suit is not.

That's all there is to it. The 10 Practice Deals are worth 10,000 more words.

Board: 1  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3♥  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♥2

Board: 2  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3♥  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♣J

Board: 3  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 3♠  
Declarer: South  
Lead: ♦K

Board: 4  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: West  
Lead: ♣7

Board: 5  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♦7

Board: 6  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♥K

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ K 3

♦ J 5 3 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ 8 3

♥ Q J 9 7 6 4

♦ K 7

♣ 9 6 4



♠ A Q 10 4

♥ 10 8 2

♦ Q 9 8

♣ Q J 5

♠ 9 7 5

♥ A 5

♦ A 10 6 4

♣ A K 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

Lead: ♥2

At favorable vulnerability you decided to open 2♥.

In reply to partner's Ogust 2NT you say 3♣, showing a minimum hand along with a poor suit. Partner says 3♥ and you gratefully pass.

**Board 2**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 5  
♥ 8 5  
♦ A 10 6 4  
♣ A K 8 2

♠ K Q 10 9

♥ A 3

♦ 5 3 2

♣ Q 7 5 3



♠ 8 3

♥ K 10 9 7 6 4

♦ K 7

♣ 9 6 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q J 9 8

♣ J 10

With four top tricks it is tempting to go straight to 4♥.

But you use discretion and bid an Ogust 2NT instead. Partner responds 3♣.

Partner's 3♣ bid shows a weak hand and a poor suit. So you reluctantly settle for 3♥.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            | Pass  | 2♥   | Pass  |
| 2NT        | Pass  | 3♣   | Pass  |
| 3♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 3♥ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣J   |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7  
♥ J 4 3  
♦ K Q J 10 9  
♣ 10 7 3

♠ J 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A K 8 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 6 3

♥ K Q 10 9 7

♦ 2

♣ Q J 5 4

♠ K Q 10 8 5 4

♥ 8 5

♦ 7 6 4

♣ 9 2

At favorable vulnerability you decided to open 2♠.

In reply to partner's Ogust 2NT you say 3♦, showing a minimum hand along with a good suit. Partner says 3♠ and you pass.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 2♠    |
| Pass        | 2NT   | Pass | 3♦    |
| Pass        | 3♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦K    |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 8 7 5 3

♥ K Q 3

♦ 9 7

♣ 10 4

♠ A 10 4

♥ J 9 7 6 2

♦ K 8 5

♣ 7 3



♠ K 6

♥ A 8 5

♦ A 10 6 4

♣ A 9 8 2

♠ 9 2

♥ 10 4

♦ Q J 3 2

♣ K Q J 6 5

With three top tricks it is tempting to go straight to 4♠.

But you use discretion and bid an Ogust 2NT instead. Partner responds 3♥.

Partner's 3♥ bid shows a maximum hand and a poor suit. Your ♠K should be enough help for the suit, and with three outside Aces you bid 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♣7

**Board 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 3  
♥ 5 4 3  
♦ K Q J 10 2  
♣ J 4 3

♠ K 10 9 8 5 4

♥ K Q

♦ 9 6 4

♣ 7 5



♠ A Q 7  
♥ J 10 9 8 7  
♦ 7  
♣ Q 10 9 2

♠ J 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A K 8 6

Having opened 2♠, you reply to partner's Ogust 2NT bid with 3♥, showing a maximum hand but with a poor suit. Partner says 4♠ and you pass.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♦ 7

**Board 6**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 6 2  
 ♥ 8 4  
 ♦ A Q 9 8 7 3  
 ♣ 7 4

♠ Q 7 5 4

♥ J 6 3 2

♦ J 10

♣ K Q 5



♠ A 9 3

♥ A 7 5

♦ K 6 5 4

♣ A 8 2

♠ K J 8

♥ K Q 10 9

♦ 2

♣ J 10 9 6 3

You could just guess between pass, 3NT, or 5♦.

But you use Ogust instead. Partner responds 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a minimum hand but a good suit, which should mean two of the top three honors. Your ♦K tells you that partner has a 6-card ♦ suit headed by the A Q. With three outside Aces you can count 9 tricks - you bid 3NT.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | Pass  |
| 2♦          | Pass  | 2NT  | Pass  |
| 3♦          | Pass  | 3NT  |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥K    |       |      |       |